ISBA 4797

Capstone Project

Fall 2025 • Weekly at mutually agreed time • Online via Zoom

Course Description

This course presents a student with a challenge and an opportunity to build a portfolio-worthy project to solve a real business problem by integrating business and technical knowledge and skills. For employers, it represents a clear snapshot of a student's understanding of the subject matter and their ability to identify a meaningful project and exercise initiative. It also presents students with first-hand experience to develop project management, teamwork, and communication skills critical for a career in the Information Systems & Business Analytics field. A project proposal and instructor consent are required.

Prerequisites: ISBA 3710; ISBA 3730 or CMSI 185; BCOR 3750, all with a grade of C- (1.7) or higher. ISBA 3720 or ISBA 4796 with an approved Capstone Project proposal.

Instructor

Professor Greg Lontok

With my business and tech background, I will do my best to equip you with the skills and tools to make a meaningful impact in any organization.

Email:	gregory.lontok@lmu.edu
Office:	Hilton 114
Office Hours:	By appointmentWed 1:45 PM – 2:45 PM, Fri 8:00 AM – 1:00 PM
LinkedIn:	linkedin.com/in/greglontok
Zoom Room:	https://lmula.zoom.us/my/lontok

Course Outcomes

Upon completion of this course, students are expected to be able to:

1. Develop a formal requirements document to define a proposed system's business value, functionality, and implementation plan.
2. Apply an agile project management methodology to organize and manage resources to complete a project.
3. Develop and refine oral, written, and visual communication to productively engage a project's stakeholders.
4. Learn to acquire new technical skills to fulfill a project's deliverables while integrating pre-existing technical knowledge.

CBA Core Learning Objectives

- Demonstrate an understanding of the core concepts in information systems
- Proficient in choosing appropriate methodologies, models, and techniques to develop estimates and project management plans for information systems projects

- Accurately utilize methodologies, tools, and models to transform business requirements into operational information systems

Deliverables

Student learning is evaluated through the following Sprint-based assessments:

Deliverable	Percentage
Stakeholder Interview	5%
PRD	10%
Sprint 01	15%
Sprint 02	25%
Sprint 03	45%
TOTAL	**100%**

All issues regarding grading must be brought to the course instructor's attention within one week (7 calendar days) from the date of the posting of the grade on Brightspace. After one week from being posted, the grade becomes permanent.

Grading Scale

93-100 **A**	90-92 **A-**	88-89 **B+**	83-87 **B**	80-82 **B-**
78-79 **C+**	73-77 **C**	70-72 **C-**	60-69 **D**	< 60 **F**

Rubric

Points	Item	Description
10	**Meeting Preparation and Attendance**	**3 - Excellent:** • Scheduled all meetings with clear, advanced notice to relevant participants. • Attended all meetings punctually, without any unexcused absences or tardiness. • Gave advanced notice with a valid reason for any potential delays or absences. • Demonstrated professional behavior, including active participation, focus, and respect for others' contributions. • Prepared and distributed a detailed agenda in advance, ensuring all attendees understood the meeting goals. • Accurately recorded meeting notes and action items in Confluence, organizing them clearly and distributing them promptly.
		2 - Fair: • Scheduled meetings with notice but occasionally lacked clarity or sufficient lead time. • Attended most meetings punctually but was occasionally late or missed a meeting without sufficient notice. • Gave some notice for delays or absences, but not consistently in advance. • Showed mostly professional behavior, but the meeting tenor or focus was inconsistent. • Prepared an agenda, but it was either incomplete or not distributed in a timely manner. • Recorded meeting notes and action items in Confluence, but some details were missing or disorganized.
		1 - Poor: • Meetings were scheduled with little or no notice, causing confusion or inconvenience. • Frequently late to or absent from meetings, with no advance notice or valid reason. • Professional behavior was lacking, including poor focus, interruptions, or disengagement during meetings. • No agenda was prepared or distributed, leading to unstructured meeting goals and inefficiencies. • Meeting notes and action items were not recorded in Confluence or were incomplete, disorganized, or not shared.

Points	Item	Description
35	Jira Sprint Backlog	**3 - Excellent:** • Sprint backlog contains a sufficient number of issues to fully utilize team capacity for a 2-week sprint. • Sprint is started on time with no delays. • All issues are clearly prioritized in alignment with sprint goals and team commitments. • All issues are fully detailed, including: - Title - Description - Assignee - Story point estimate - Evidence of progress and completion (comments, links, attachments) - Relevant documentation or links • Team members demonstrate active participation in backlog grooming, ensuring issues are well-defined and understood by all.
		2 - Fair: • Sprint backlog includes a reasonable number of issues but does not fully utilize team capacity for a 2-week sprint. • Sprint is delayed by up to 1 day due to issues lacking sufficient detail or planning. • Some issues are prioritized, but there are gaps or inconsistencies in aligning priorities with sprint goals. • Most issues are sufficiently detailed, but some are missing minor elements like subtasks, comments, or full descriptions. • Limited team involvement in backlog grooming, leading to minor misunderstandings or inefficiencies.
		1 - Poor: • Sprint backlog significantly underestimates the number of issues needed to meet the team's capacity for a 2-week sprint. • Sprint is started more than 1 day late due to insufficient preparation. • Issues are not prioritized or lack clear alignment with sprint objectives. • Many issues are incomplete or missing critical details, such as: - Complete description - Story point estimate - Evidence of progress and completion (comments, links, attachments) - Relevant documentation or links • Minimal or no team involvement in backlog grooming, resulting in unclear or undefined issues that block progress.
10	GitHub Code and README Updates	**3 - Excellent:** • Commits are made regularly and align with project milestones, showing clear incremental progress. • Commit messages are descriptive, meaningful, and follow established format (e.g., "Fix bug in user authentication flow"). • README is comprehensive, up-to-date, and includes the required sections. • README effectively communicates the project's purpose and status to both technical and non-technical audiences.
		2 - Fair: • Commits are made inconsistently, with periods of inactivity or commits that do not reflect steady progress. • Commit messages are present but often vague or lacking detail (e.g., "Update code" or "Fix bug"). • README is mostly complete but missing some recent updates in key areas such as installation instructions or installation instructions). • README provides a general understanding of the project but lacks clarity or detail in some areas.
		1 - Poor: • Commits are rare, with significant gaps in version control activity. • Commit messages are unclear, uninformative, or missing altogether. • README is outdated, incomplete, or poorly organized, making it difficult to understand the project's purpose or use. • Key details are missing from the README, such as setup instructions, project description, or relevant links, hindering collaboration or usability.

Points	Item	Description
40	Sprint Review Presentation	**3 - Excellent:** • Demonstrates significant incremental progress with a working product feature that fully aligns with the sprint goal. • The feature operates as intended, with no critical bugs or errors. • Team effectively communicates how the feature contributes to the overall product, using clear and professional demos. • Feedback from stakeholders is solicited and incorporated into future plans.
		2 - Fair: • Demonstrates incremental progress with a partially functional feature, but with some direction is clear. • Some aspects of the feature require workarounds or temporary fixes, but the overall direction is clear. • Team explains the current limitations and outlines a realistic plan to address them. • Stakeholders are engaged but provide limited or mixed feedback on progress.
		1 - Poor: • Unable to demonstrate meaningful progress toward the sprint goal due to incomplete or non-functional product features. • Major blockers or bugs prevent the feature from being useful or operational. • Team struggles to clearly articulate challenges, and plans to resolve issues are vague or undefined. • Stakeholder feedback highlights significant gaps in progress or understanding of priorities.
5	Sprint Retrospective	**3 - Excellent:** • Thoughtful insights are shared, reflecting deep reflection on team performance and the sprint process. • Actionable improvements are proposed, with specific methods to address challenges or enhance future sprints. • Celebrates successes and acknowledges individual or team achievements.
		2 - Fair: • Provides general feedback with some relevance to team performance and the sprint process. • Suggestions for improvement are limited or lack actionable detail.
		1 - Poor: • Feedback is vague, unrelated to the sprint, or non-existent. • No actionable suggestions for improvement are provided, or suggestions are impractical. • Successes and achievements are ignored or undervalued.
100	TOTAL	

Course Schedule

Week	Date	Due
1	Aug 24 – Aug 30	Sprint Zero Meeting
2	Aug 31 – Sep 6	Stakeholder Interview
3	Sep 7 – Sep 13	PRD Sprint 01 Planning
4	Sep 14 – Sep 20	Sprint 01 Standup
5	Sep 21 – Sep 27	Sprint 01 Standup
6	Sep 28 – Oct 4	Sprint 01 Review Sprint 01 Retrospective
7	Oct 5 – Oct 11	Sprint 02 Planning
8	Oct 12 – Oct 18	Sprint 02 Standup
9	Oct 19 – Oct 25	Sprint 02 Standup
10	Oct 26 – Nov 1	Sprint 02 Review Sprint 02 Retrospective
11	Nov 2 – Nov 8	Sprint 03 Planning
12	Nov 9 – Nov 15	Sprint 03 Standup
13	Nov 16 – Nov 22	Sprint 03 Standup
14	*Nov 23 – Nov 29*	*Thanksgiving Holiday*
15	Nov 30 – Dec 6	Sprint 03 Review Sprint 03 Retrospective

Course Policies

Text/Material

- Schwaber, K., Sutherland, J. (2020) *The Scrum Guide*
- O'Reilly

The rest of the material will be available on Brightspace or Teams.

Workload Expectation

According to LMU Credit Hour Policy, students are expected to spend a minimum of twelve hours of activities related to the course.

Netiquette

In the work-from-home era, everyone is expected to abide by the following professional etiquette during online interactions:

- **Avoid Embarrassing Mistakes:** keep your audio mute if you are not talking.
- **Designate Your Workspace:** create a quiet and professional workspace preferably facing window or light for a better video. Never laying on bed or couch.
- **Setup Your Tech:** check your wi-fi and test your audio and video beforehand.

- **Communicate with the Host:** stay engaged by using Zoom buttons for raising your hand, responding yes/no, and the messaging tool for asking questions.
- **Be Professional:** be on time, dress and act appropriately as you do in class.

Academic Integrity Policy

Loyola Marymount University is a community dedicated to academic excellence, student-centered education, and the Jesuit and Marymount traditions. As such, the University expects all members of its community to act with honesty and integrity at all times, especially in their academic work. Academic honesty respects the intellectual and creative work of others, flows from dedication to and pride in performing one's own best work, and is essential if true learning is to take place. It is your responsibility to make sure that your work meets the standard of academic honesty set forth in the "LMU Honor Policy and Procedures" (see http://academics.lmu.edu/honesty)

Violations of the University's academic code include, but are not limited to possession of, or use of unauthorized materials during assignments and exams; providing information to another student; or copying the work of another person. Violations may result in academic penalties, including receiving an "F" in this course.

Special Accommodations

Students with special needs who require reasonable modifications, special assistance, or accommodations in this course should promptly direct their request to the Disability Support Services (DSS) Office. Any student who currently has a documented disability (ADHD, Autism Spectrum Disorder, Learning, Physical, or Psychiatric) needing academic accommodations should contact the DSS Office (Daum Hall 2nd floor, 310-338-4216) as early in the semester as possible. All discussions will remain confidential. Please visit http://www.lmu.edu/dss for additional information.

Emergency Preparedness

To report an emergency or suspicious activity, contact the LMU Department of Public Safety by phone (x222 or 310-338-2893) or at the nearest emergency call box. In the event of an evacuation, follow the evacuation signage throughout the building to the designated safe refuge area where you will receive further instruction from Public Safety or a Building Captain. For more safety information and preparedness tips, visit http://www.lmu.edu/emergency.

Tentative Nature of the Syllabus

If necessary, this syllabus and its contents are subject to revision; students are responsible for any changes or modifications announced or distributed in class or posted on Brightspace or Teams.